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25 Years After Towers Fell, 2,983 Names Still Echoing

Solemn Moment to Grieve and Remember

By MICHAEL WILSON

Americans born since that day. Some people used their turns at the microphone to criticize the federal government for continuing to work with Saudi Arabia after the Sept. 11 attacks. Family members of those who died have sought to hold the kingdom responsible in federal court, claiming that its government provided support for the hijackers. Among them was Terry Strada, an official with 9/11 Families United, whose husband was killed in the attack. Her organization has tried for years to pursue legal action against the Saudi government. The kingdom has denied involvement. "It has been one betrayal after another," Ms. Strada said. She urged the assembled elected officials to "stand with survivors, stand with Americans."

Later, a nephew of Lisa Marie Terry, who died in the attack, accused "the deep state" of hiding the truth. He called on President Trump to "release the unredacted files that implicate Saudi Arabia, while what's left of the victims' families are still alive to see it."

Four living former presidents, from Bill Clinton to Joseph R. Biden Jr., stood silently nearby.

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In Taliban-Ruled Afghanistan, Al Qaeda Is Finding a Refuge

By ELIAN PELTIER

KABUL, Afghanistan — Twenty-five years ago, Osama bin Laden led the planning of Al Qaeda's attacks on Sept. 11, 2001, from a Taliban stronghold in Afghanistan, where he lived as their guest.

Now, the Taliban rule over Afghanistan once again, trying to present a more modern face to the world.

But despite the veneer, the Taliban have not changed their ideology, and armed groups, including dozens of Qaeda members, remain in Afghanistan. Many of the conditions that made the Sept. 11 attacks possible remain.

The Taliban outlasted the American war to oust them and are now ruling over 45 million Afghans. They use the latest iPhones to contact European and American diplomats. They travel to the Persian Gulf and Turkey, and promote trade with Uzbekistan and India. Their fighters now patrol Afghanistan's cities, some using abandoned U.S. military gear.

And when Taliban officials receive foreign visitors in their gilded offices in Kabul, the capital, they insist that they want peaceful relations with the world.

They repeat the commitments they made in 2020, during peace talks with the United States, not to allow another major attack to take root on Afghan soil.

"We consider the chapter of war to have come to an end," Afghanistan's foreign minister, Amir Khan Muttaqi, said in a recent interview in Kabul.

But the United States, the European Union and most other governments are not ready to trust them.

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Girls going home after school in Badakhshan Province.



MANHATTAN At the memorial pools, visitors can read the etched names of the people who died.



ARLINGTON, VA. A memorial service at the Pentagon, which was hit in the attacks on Sept. 11, 2001.



SHANKSVILLE, PA. Ryan Gould's family viewed his grandfather's name on a Flight 93 memorial.

Contractor Admits Fault in Reflecting Pool Flub

By DAVID A. FAHRENTHOLD and MAXINE JOSELOW

WASHINGTON — The contractor that renovated the Lincoln Memorial Reflecting Pool has told the Trump administration that errors in its own work and flaws in the repair plan, not vandalism, caused the pool's new blue liner to peel and break loose, according to government documents reviewed by The New York Times.

President Trump has repeatedly blamed vandals wielding knives or box cutters for damage to the pool's "American flag blue"

The documents include Atlantic's reports to the government as well as daily progress updates from the National Park Service over the past two months.

Atlantic blamed its own errors in a report dated Aug. 14 and then provided more detail on Sept. 2, the documents show. The Justice Department, which had charged several people with vandalizing the pool in early July, began moving to dismiss the cases on July 31.

Because of "human oversight," workers in some areas did not spray enough of the primer that

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INTERNATIONAL A4-10

Trump Reopens Old Wounds
President Trump is not the first U.S. president to feud with Canada. But he has thrown the relationship into what might be its worst crisis ever. PAGE A10

Apple Enters the Foldable Phone Fray. Why?

Apple this week unveiled an iPhone that unfolds like a book to expand its screen size and closes up to fit in your pocket. It's the biggest physical change to the iPhone's design in nearly two decades.

But even though they've been around for years, foldable phones aren't particularly popular. They're expensive, awkward and not as durable as regular smartphones. So why did Apple build one?

The simple answer is that the novel design of today's foldable phones could help re-establish the high end of the phone market. They are meant to stand out in a sea of standard-issue, if-you've-seen-one-you've-seen-them-all smartphones.

The quintessential rectangular smartphones have gotten so good over the years that the most expensive models priced upward of \$1,000 have become nearly indistinguishable from their cheaper counterparts. (Carrying a phone with three

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BUSINESS B1-5

Caveat in Box Office Boom
Strong box office sales this summer have Hollywood celebrating. But a closer look at the numbers offers a sobering reality check. PAGE B5

ARTS C1-6

An Actor Grows Into a Role
Jacob Tremblay, who gained acclaim as the child star of the films "Room" and "Wonder," is playing the lead in the upcoming film "Unabomber." PAGE C1

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THE WEATHER

Today, sunshine giving way to clouds, high 79. Tonight, cloudy, heavy rain late, low 70. Tomorrow, morning rain and thunderstorms, high 81. Weather map, Page B12.

TEHRAN'S PROXIES STRENGTHEN GRIP OVER THE RED SEA

CAPTURE OF KEY ISLAND

Houthi's Gains in Yemen Threaten a Second Saudi Oil Route

This article is by Adam Rasgon, Shuaib Almusawa, Saeed Al-Batati and Praveen Baskar.

TEL AVIV — The Iranian-backed Houthi militia seized an island in a choke point of the Red Sea after days of fierce fighting, two Yemeni government officials said Friday, giving Iran and its allies sway over the two main routes for shipping oil out of the Middle East.

The capture of Perim Island came as Saudi Arabia announced that it had shut down a critical oil pipeline, a day after Houthi forces swept into the strategic port city of Mokha in Yemen. Both were major setbacks for the Saudi kingdom, which exports most of its oil through the Red Sea. The kingdom's foreign ministry said the pipeline was hit on Thursday by drones launched from Iraq.

Perim Island sits in the middle of the Bab al-Mandab Strait, the narrow pathway at the southern entrance to the Red Sea. Its seizure adds a new dimension in the war between the United States and Iran.

The Islamic Republic has already largely cut off the flow of oil through the Strait of Hormuz in the Persian Gulf and leveraged that influence to demand concessions from Washington. Now, the Houthi militia, Iran's ally, has a foothold at a bottleneck in the Red Sea and could further disrupt shipping there.

The island's capture came after intense ground battles in Yemen as the Houthis have staged a lightning advance against forces allied with the internationally recognized Yemeni government, which is backed by Saudi Arabia. The kingdom has faced frequent Houthi attacks on its tankers and energy facilities, even as its leaders have tried to avoid a direct war with the group, analysts say.

Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman of Saudi Arabia spoke to President Trump about the escalation in Yemen in calls this week, and urged the United States to take military action against the Houthis, according to officials with knowledge of the conversations. Mr. Trump told him he was not willing to do so, the officials said.

Mr. Trump, however, told the crown prince, the de facto Saudi leader, that he would continue to assist in intelligence and targeting.

A senior administration official

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Apple's \$1,999 iPhone Duo.